GRACE THAT DOESN’T LET GO

1 Corinthians 16:19–24

Pre-Sermon Booklet | Brian Tarpy | October 25, 2026

BIG IDEA

The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ calls us to love Him, binds us together in His church, and sustains us to the end.

THE TEXT IN ONE BREATH

Greet one another in Christ. Love the Lord. Receive His grace. Remember the apostle’s love for the church.

WHY THESE VERSES MATTER

After confronting divisions, disorder, and doctrinal confusion, Paul ends with warm greetings, a sober warning, a prayer for Christ’s coming, and grace and love.

READ WITH THIS QUESTION

How can Paul finish such a corrective letter with both a solemn warning and such tender words of grace?

SIX TRUTHS FROM PAUL'S FAREWELL

1. A CHURCH CONNECTED	The churches of Asia and the household of Aquila and Prisca greet Corinth in the Lord (v. 19).
2. HOLY AFFECTION	The believers greet one another; a holy kiss expresses their family bond in Christ (v. 20).
3. PERSONAL COMMITMENT	Paul adds a greeting in his own hand, marking his personal care and authority (v. 21).
4. LOVE FOR CHRIST MATTERS	Paul warns those who do not love the Lord; grace never makes indifference to Christ harmless (v. 22).
5. THE LORD IS COMING	"Maranatha" points toward the Lord's coming and the church's hope (v. 22).
6. GRACE AND LOVE REMAIN	Paul closes with Christ's grace and his own love for all who are in Christ Jesus (vv. 23–24).

WARNING + GRACE

The same letter that exposes sin also proclaims the grace that restores sinners to Christ.

APPLICATION SCENARIOS

WHEN CHURCH RELATIONSHIPS STRAIN:

Remember that Christians belong to one another in Christ. Pursue reconciliation rather than factions.

WHEN TRUTH IS UNCOMFORTABLE:

Take Paul’s warning seriously. Love for Jesus includes loyalty to His Word.

WHEN FAITH FEELS WEAK:

Look to the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, not your own strength, for endurance.

WHEN YOU MEET ANOTHER BELIEVER:

Offer sincere welcome and practical care. Christian fellowship should be visible.

GOSPEL FOCUS

Jesus Christ died and rose for sinners. His grace is not earned by our love; rather, His saving grace awakens love for Him and gathers us into His people.

KINGDOM APPLICATION

Christ’s reign forms a people who speak truth, love one another, and live in readiness for their returning Lord.

PREPARE YOUR HEART FOR SUNDAY

HEAD — WHAT DO I NEED TO KNOW?

Why does Paul join a warning about not loving Christ with a blessing of grace?

HEART — WHAT DO I NEED TO LOVE?

Is my love for Christ evident in my love for His people?

HANDS — WHAT DO I NEED TO DO?

Whom can I welcome, encourage, forgive, or serve this week?

INVITATION QUESTION

Am I resting in Christ's grace and responding to Him with genuine love?

WITNESSING STATEMENT

"The grace of Jesus does more than forgive me. It gives me a new Lord to love and a family to belong to."

MEMORY VERSE

"The grace of the Lord Jesus be with you. My love be with you all in Christ Jesus. Amen." — 1 Corinthians 16:23–24 (ESV)

ONE-SENTENCE TAKEAWAY

The grace that saves us also teaches us to love Christ and His people.